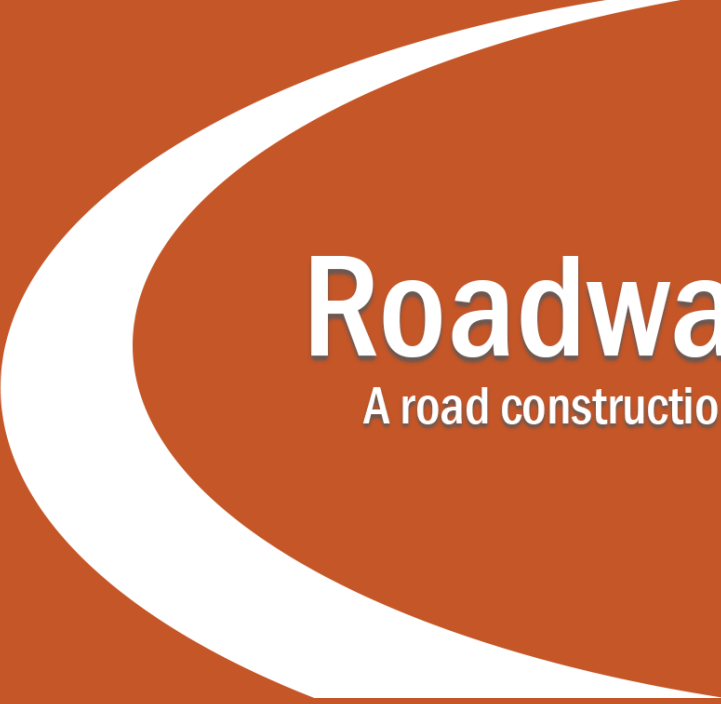




Roadway Safety +

A road construction industry training program

High Visibility Clothing

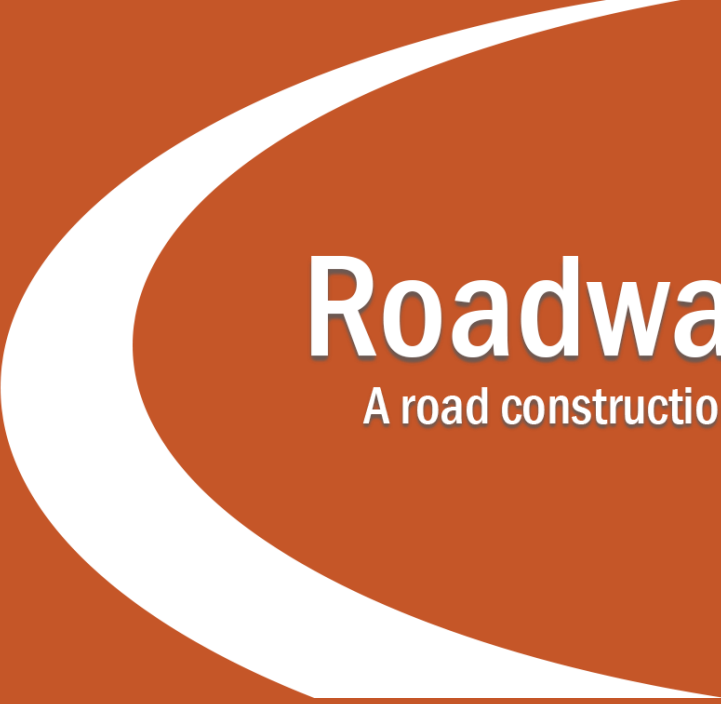
Being seen by others while in a work zone may save your life and the lives of others around you. Wearing high visibility clothing, a form of personal protective equipment (PPE), is required by the Manual on Uniform Traffic Control Devices (MUTCD) for all roadway workers.

This material is based upon work supported by the U.S. Department of Transportation under Cooperative Agreement Nos. 693JJ31750001 and 693JJ32450004.

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Why High Visibility?



Wearing high visibility clothing, sometimes called garments, increases your chances of being seen, especially in low-light or nighttime conditions. This in turn lessens your risk of being struck by vehicles and equipment.



Photo: ARTBA

How It Works



High visibility clothing uses fluorescent colors to make you stand out in low light conditions and at long distances. It's easier to see you in bright light, low light and in the rain or snow.

High visibility clothing is striped with retroreflective tape that bounces light from headlights back to drivers, making it easier to see you at night. The tape is applied in patterns that make it easier to recognize you as a person and not a traffic cone or barrel.



Photos: ARTBA

Types of High Visibility Clothing



There are three types of high visibility clothing. The type determines who the intended wearers should be.

Type O – non-roadway occupations



Photo: Raw Pixels

Type P – law enforcement & first responders



Photo: Gila River FD

Type R – roadway occupations



Photo: 3M

Classes of High Visibility Clothing



Class 1 – does not meet the OSHA requirements for transportation construction workers.



Photos: Grainger

This picture shows Type O, Class 1 high visibility vests. The placement and the amount of retroreflective tape does not identify you as a person.

Do not wear this type of safety vest if you are working in or near the roadway, and especially not at night.

Classes of High Visibility Clothing



Class 2 – meets OSHA requirements for roadway workers and for workers who need greater visibility in inclement weather. It is appropriate for most daytime work.



Photos: Uline

This picture shows Type R, Class 2 high visibility vests. The placement and amount of retroreflective tape identifies you as a person.

A Class 2 vest alone does not provide sufficient visibility for night work.

Photos: ARTBA

Classes of High Visibility Clothing



Class 3 – meets OSHA and Federal Highway Administration (FHWA) requirements for roadway workers doing many different tasks in a wide range of weather conditions.



Photo: High-viz.com

This picture shows Type R, Class 3 high visibility vests. Notice the extra retroreflective tape on the arms and waist as compared to a Class 2 vest. The placement and amount of retroreflective tape identifies you as a person.

A Class 3 vest provides more visibility at night.

Classes of High Visibility Clothing



Class 3 Performance – meets OSHA and MUTCD requirements for roadway workers doing many different tasks in a wide range of weather conditions.

You can combine a Type R, Class 2 or Class 3 vest with Class E pants to form a Performance Class 3 ensemble.

Wearing a Performance Class 3 Ensemble provides much greater visibility at night.



Photo: Uline

Photo: 3M

Classes of High Visibility Clothing



Class E high visibility clothing includes a variety of items including:

- Gaiters
- Shorts
- Pants
- Bib overalls



Photo: High-viz.com



Photo: Safe-Fast

Class E items added to Class 2 and 3 vests creates a Performance Class 3 ensemble.

Wearing a Performance Class 3 Ensemble provides much greater visibility at night.

Care & Maintenance of High Visibility Clothing



The tag inside tells you how to care for your high visibility gear. Most high visibility clothing can be machine washed in warm water. It should not be dry cleaned, bleached, or ironed. Drying instructions will vary, so read the tag.

The tag will also tell you the class of the item and what standards it conforms to.

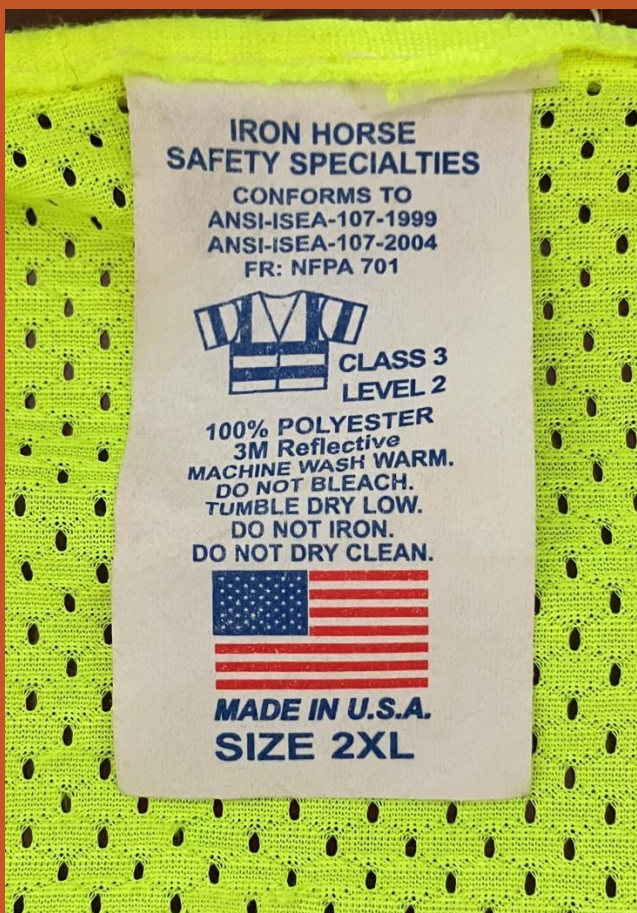


Photo: ARTBA



Photo: Francis Flinch [CC BY-SA 4.0](#)

Inspect your high visibility clothing every day. Replace worn, torn, and faded garments.

Your Responsibilities



You are responsible for showing up to the job site dressed in the appropriate PPE. For roadway work, the minimum requirement is a Class 2 safety vests for daytime work, and a Class 3 safety vest or Class 3 Ensemble for nighttime work.

You are also responsible for keeping your gear clean and asking for a replacement for anything that is faded, worn, or torn.



Photo: eCLOSH

Photo: SchaeferS on Mediawiki

Your Employer's Responsibilities



In most cases, your employer is responsible for providing high visibility clothing wherever there are work site hazards. They are also responsible for ensuring that all the workers on site are wearing the appropriate PPE.

Photo: [Pexels](#)

If you are not wearing required PPE you can be told to leave the job site and not return until you are wearing the required PPE.

Summary



This module presented information on the different types of high visibility clothing and when to wear it. High visibility clothing identifies you as a person and makes it easier for others to see you, especially at night and in low visibility situations.

Test your knowledge on the following slides by answering the quiz questions.

Quiz Question 1



True or false, the fluorescent coloring of high visibility clothing bounces light from headlights back to drivers, identifying you as a person?

Answer 1



True or false, the fluorescent coloring of high visibility clothing bounces light from headlights back to drivers, identifying you as a person?

False! Fluorescent colors help you be seen in low light and inclement weather. Retroreflective tape bounces headlights back to drivers and identifies you as a person.

Quiz Question 2



What class safety vest is appropriate for night work?

Answer 2



What class safety vest is appropriate for night work?

Class 3

Quiz Question 3



What should you do if your safety vest becomes worn or torn?

Answer 3



What should you do if your safety vest becomes worn or torn?

Ask you employer to replace it with a new one.

Quiz Question 4



4. What is a performance class 3 ensemble?

Answer 4



4. What is a performance class 3 ensemble?

A combination of a class 2 or 3 safety vest with a class E item such as pants or gaiters.

Quiz Question 5



True or false, if you show up to work without the required PPE, you can be told to leave?

Answer 5



True or false, if you show up to work without the required PPE, you can be told to leave?

True! You are responsible for showing up to work wearing the required PPE. Your employer is responsible for supplying it and ensuring you are wearing it.

Additional Resources



Types and Classes of High Visibility Clothing

(we will need to upload this document and add a link to it)